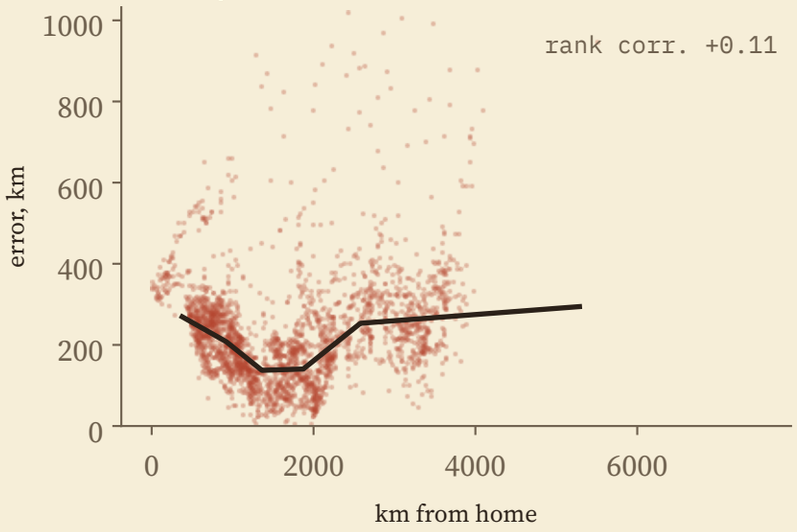
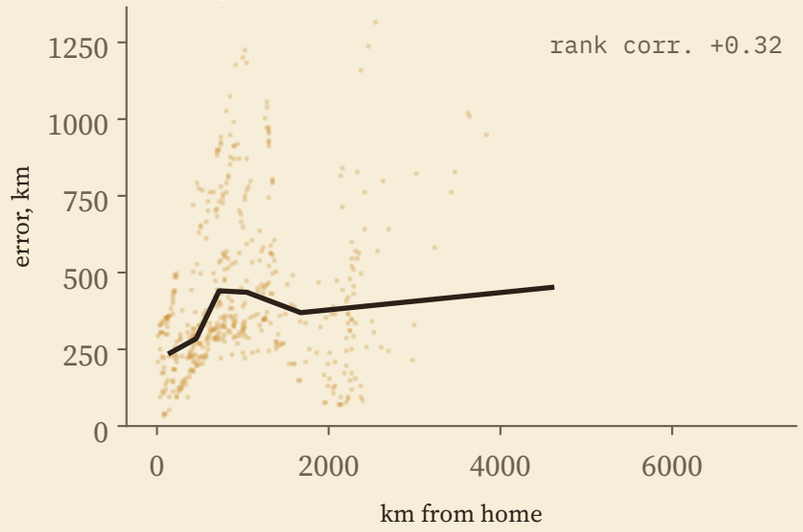
Do maps get worse away from home?

Each dot is a place: its error against its distance from the map's centre of knowledge. Line: medians of six distance bands.

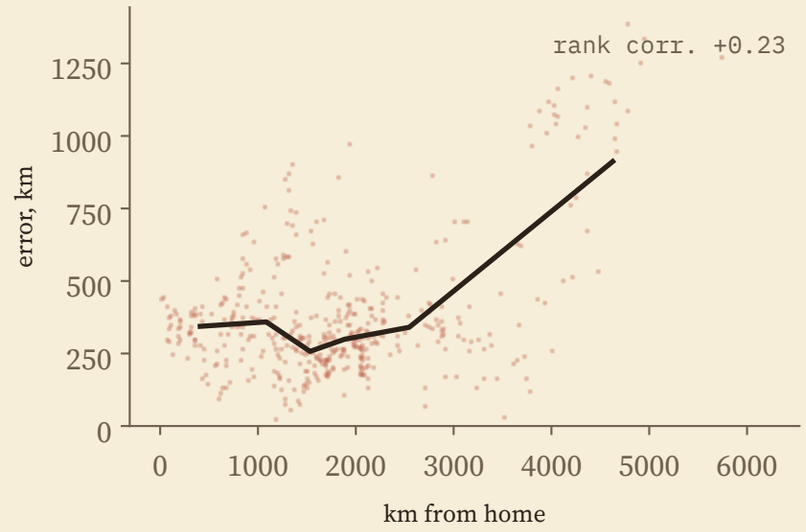
Ptolemy: from Alexandria



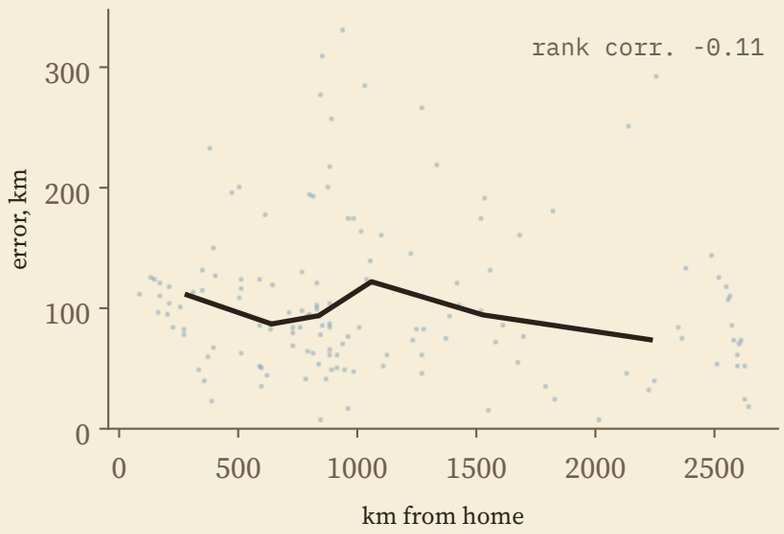
Peutinger: from Rome



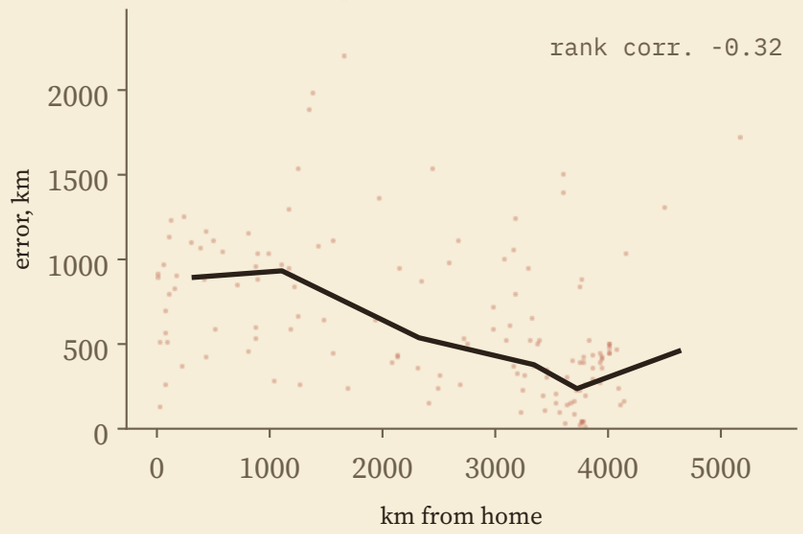
al-Idrisi: from Palermo



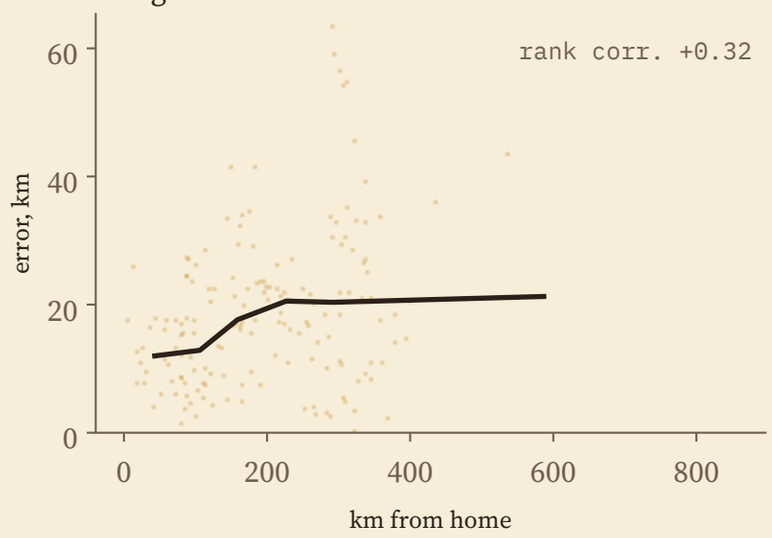
Carta Pisana: from Genoa



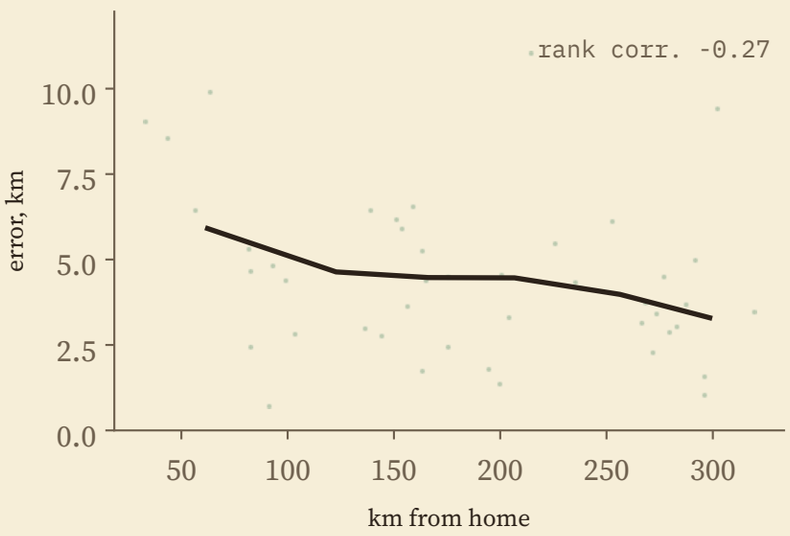
Hereford: from Jerusalem



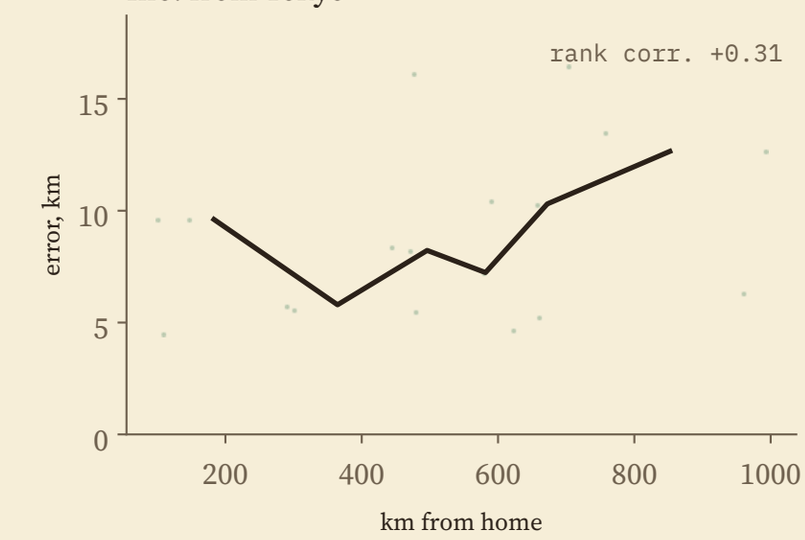
Gough: from London



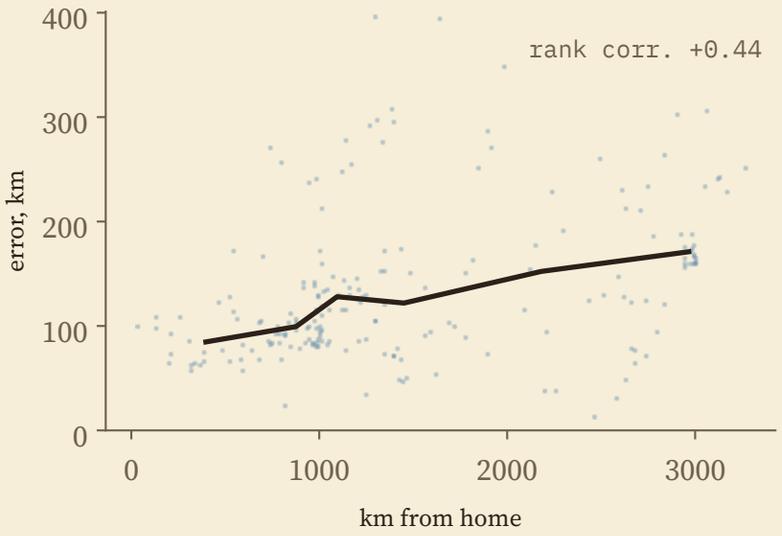
Saxton: from London



Ino: from Tokyo



Catalan Atlas: from Palma



Data: control points from eight published studies by the author (Zenodo, CC BY 4.0); Natural Earth (public domain)

maps.tristanhotham.com/map-accuracy